



FigBuild 2026

Because some moments should linger

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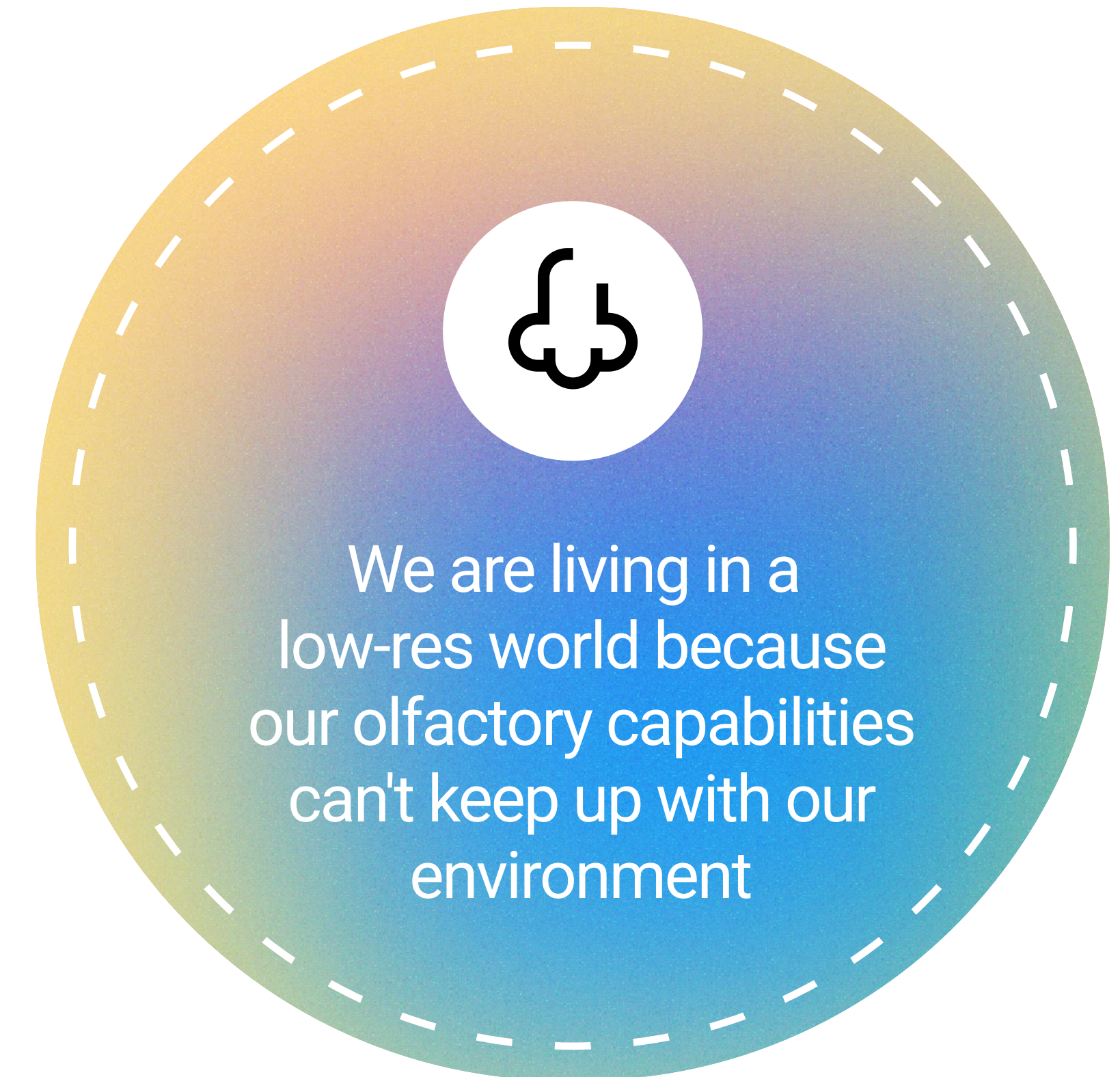
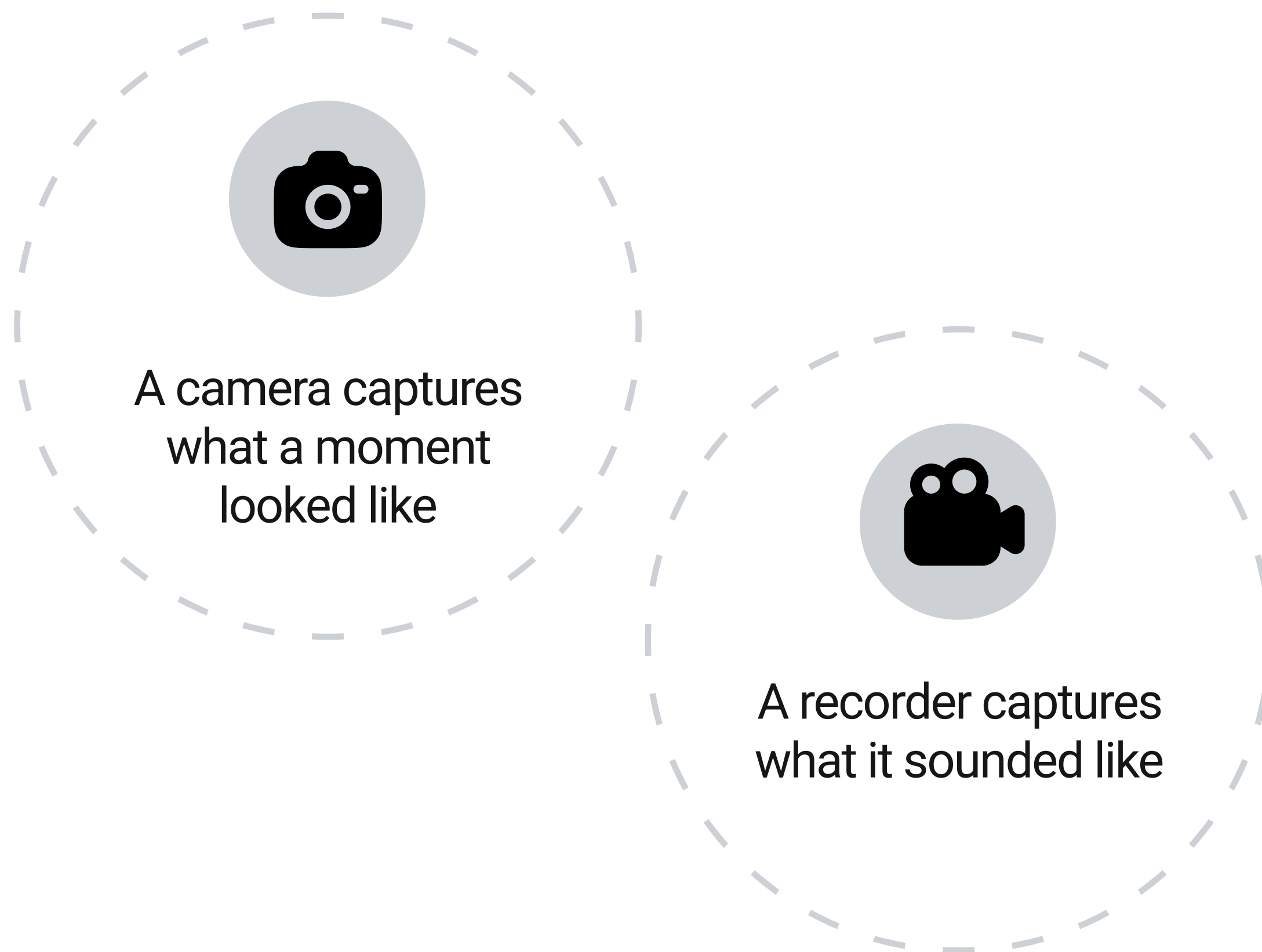
Smell is the only
sensory input that
plugs directly to *the*
brain's seat of emotion
and memory.

National Institutes of Health

yet we treat it as
**background
noise.**

The Problem

We are biologically capped at 400 receptors while the environment around us carries a richness we simply cannot process.



We have no way to archive, quantify, or re-access the scent-signatures that anchor our deepest memories.

The Invisible Gap

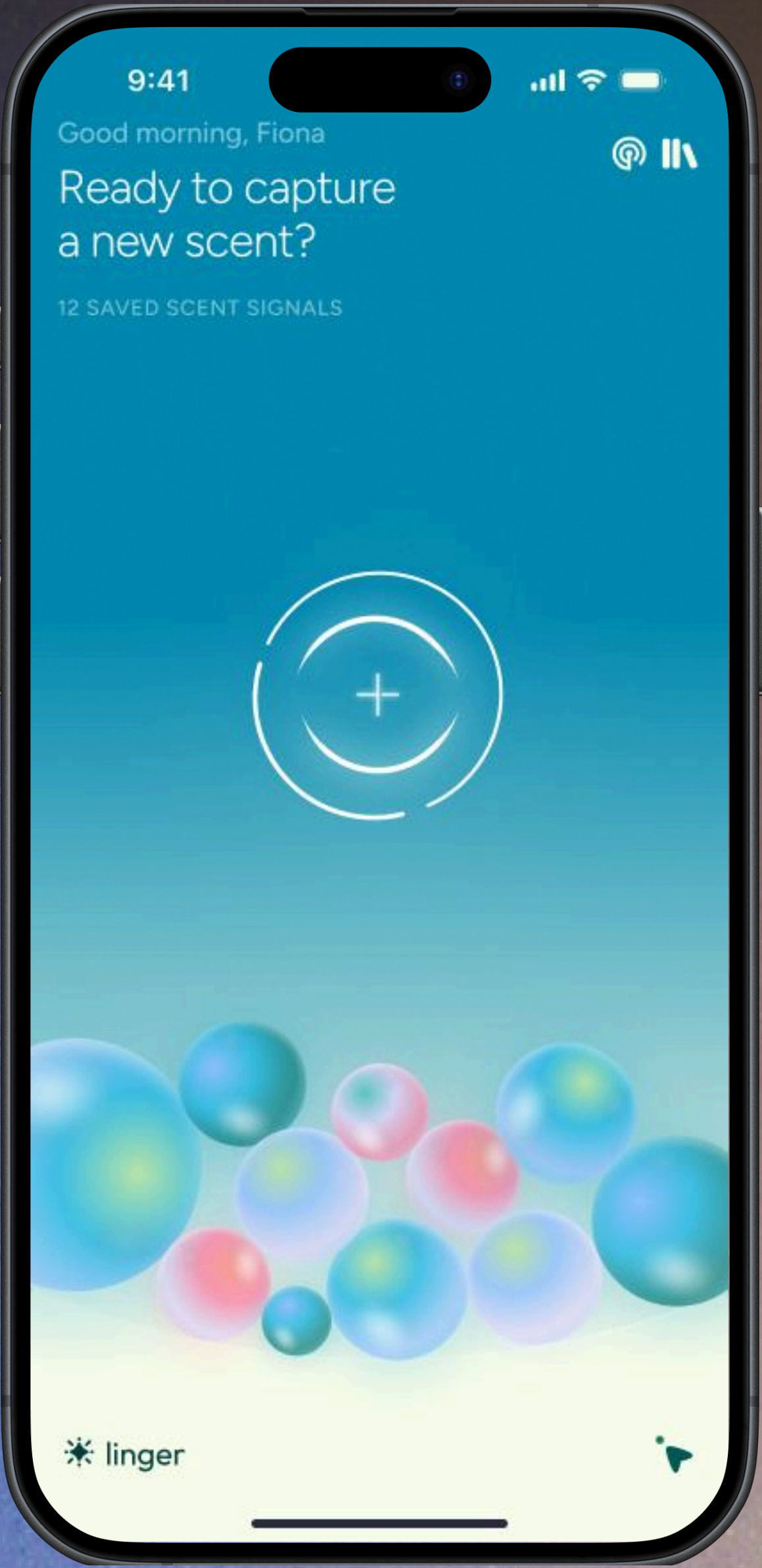
We have no way to archive, quantify, or re-access the scent-signatures that anchor our deepest memories, navigate our health, or signal social empathy.

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The Solution

Introducing **linger**

A speculative tech that closes that gap, giving us a "Heightened Sense"—the ability to perceive *Chemical and Emotional Signals* that currently operate below our conscious awareness.



The Solution

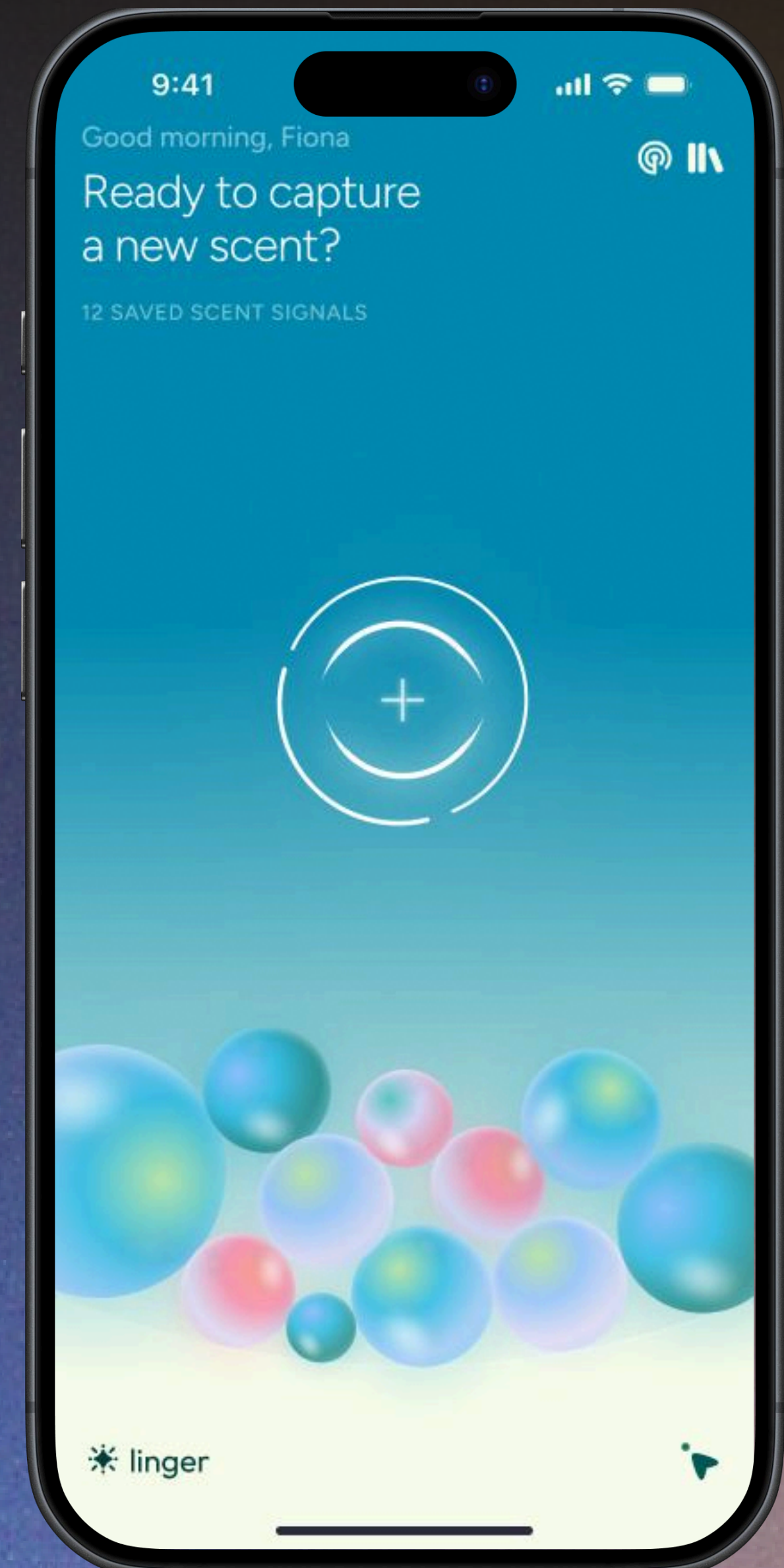
Linger (The Olfactory App)

Why it Matters:

Linger expands how humans perceive, record, and interact with scent.

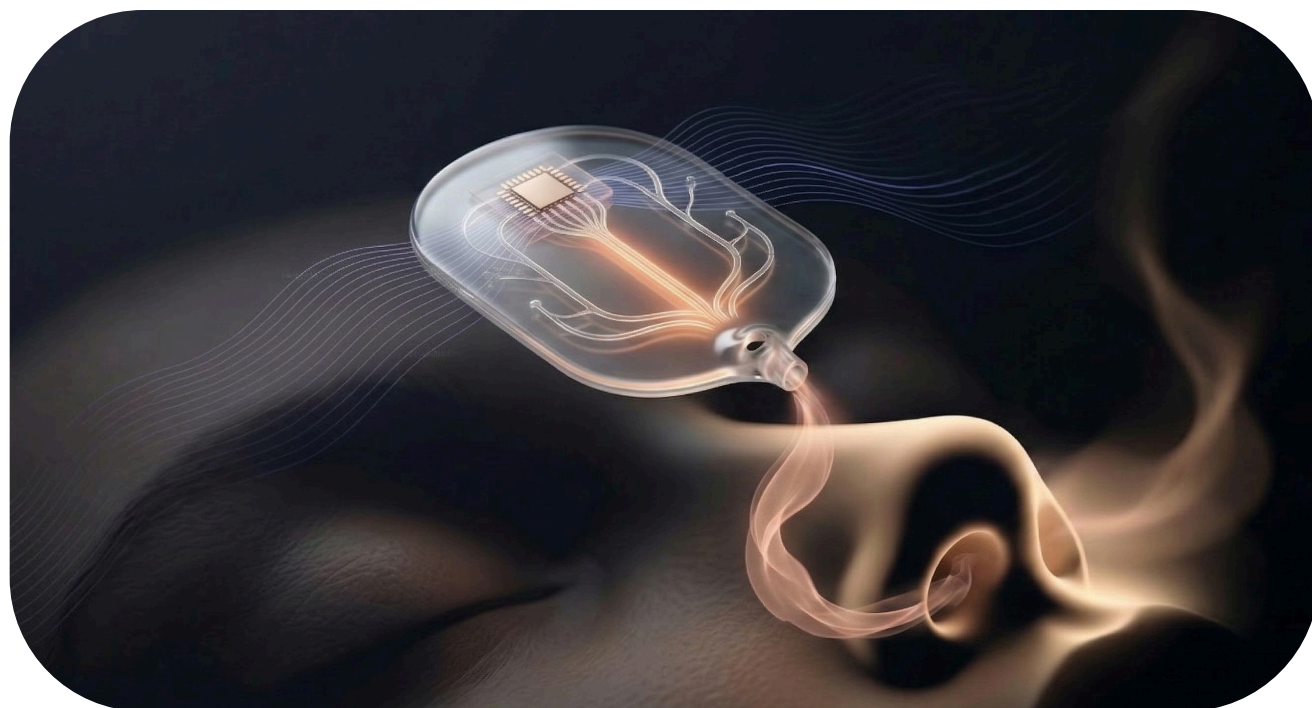
The app shifting smell from a **background noise** into a **powerful conduit and data** for memory, emotions, and overall cognition.

It allows users to achieve a desired feeling and reconnect with a sensory system that has always shaped our awareness.



Product Ecosystem

The Wearable



Linger is a two-part ecosystem.

The App is your personal archive and creative canvas where you log, map, and curate your olfactory environment.

The **Wearable** is the silent actuator which senses ambient molecular scent data, and is capable of emitting micro-doses of scents and providing haptic feedback.

Our Core Framework

We are designing Linger to help those seeking heightened sensory experience by quantifying and translating invisible molecular scents of users' lives, and turning them into forever memory signals.

Persona

Meet Emma, The Emotional Archivist

"I want a richer sensory
experience to capture the
fleeting moment or aura
of the people I love."



Our Audience

Emma The Emotional Archivist

Age

25–45 (The Digital Native generation).

Context

High-achieving, tech-literate. She has thousands of iCloud photos but feels a profound lack of presence. She is often the one documenting moments in her family.

Needs

Emotional Grounding: To bypass the "Digital Fragility" of photos and access the direct neurological backdoor to memory that only scent provides. Her goal is to use scent as a biological anchor for emotions, memory, and self-regulation.





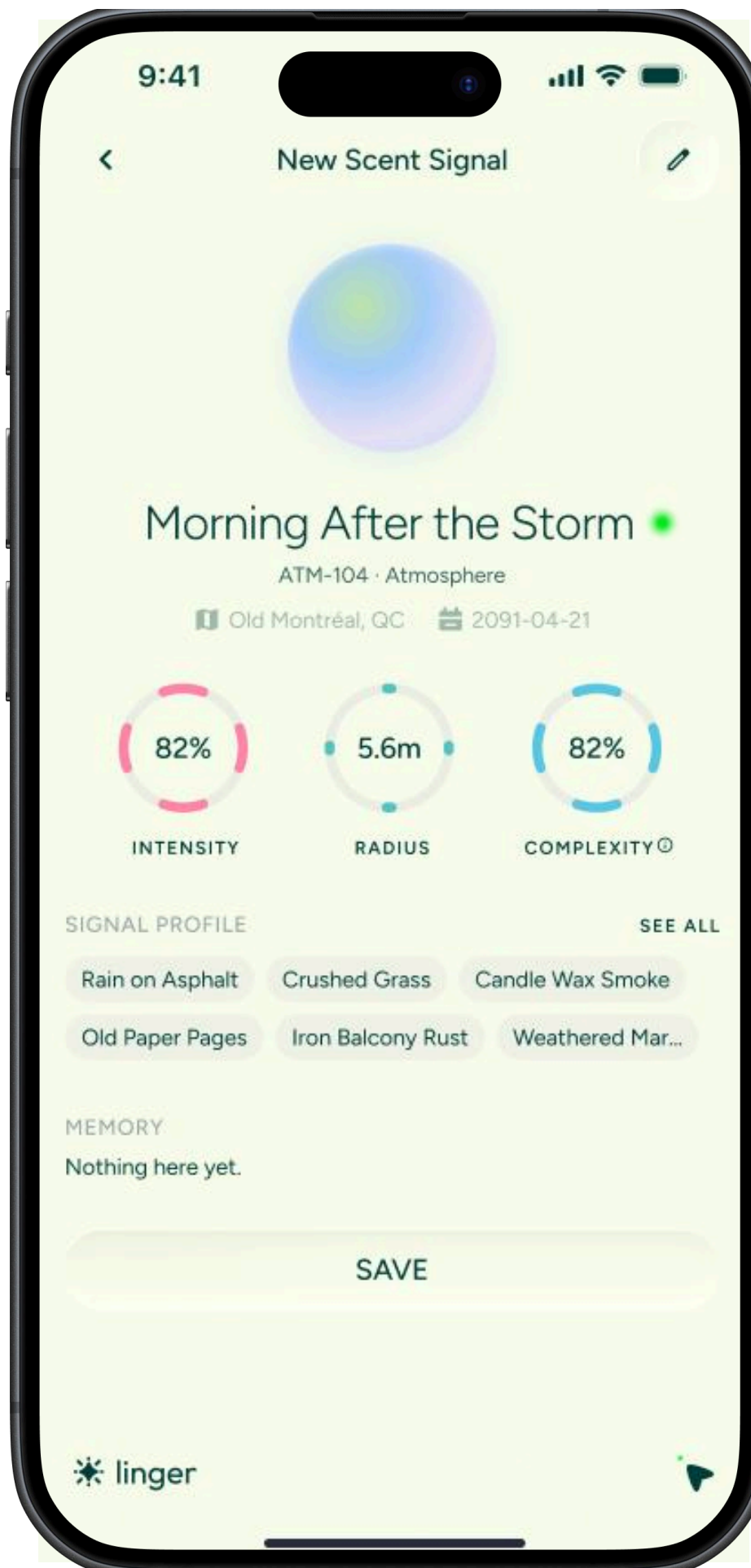
Use Case 1

Capturing the Fleeting Moment

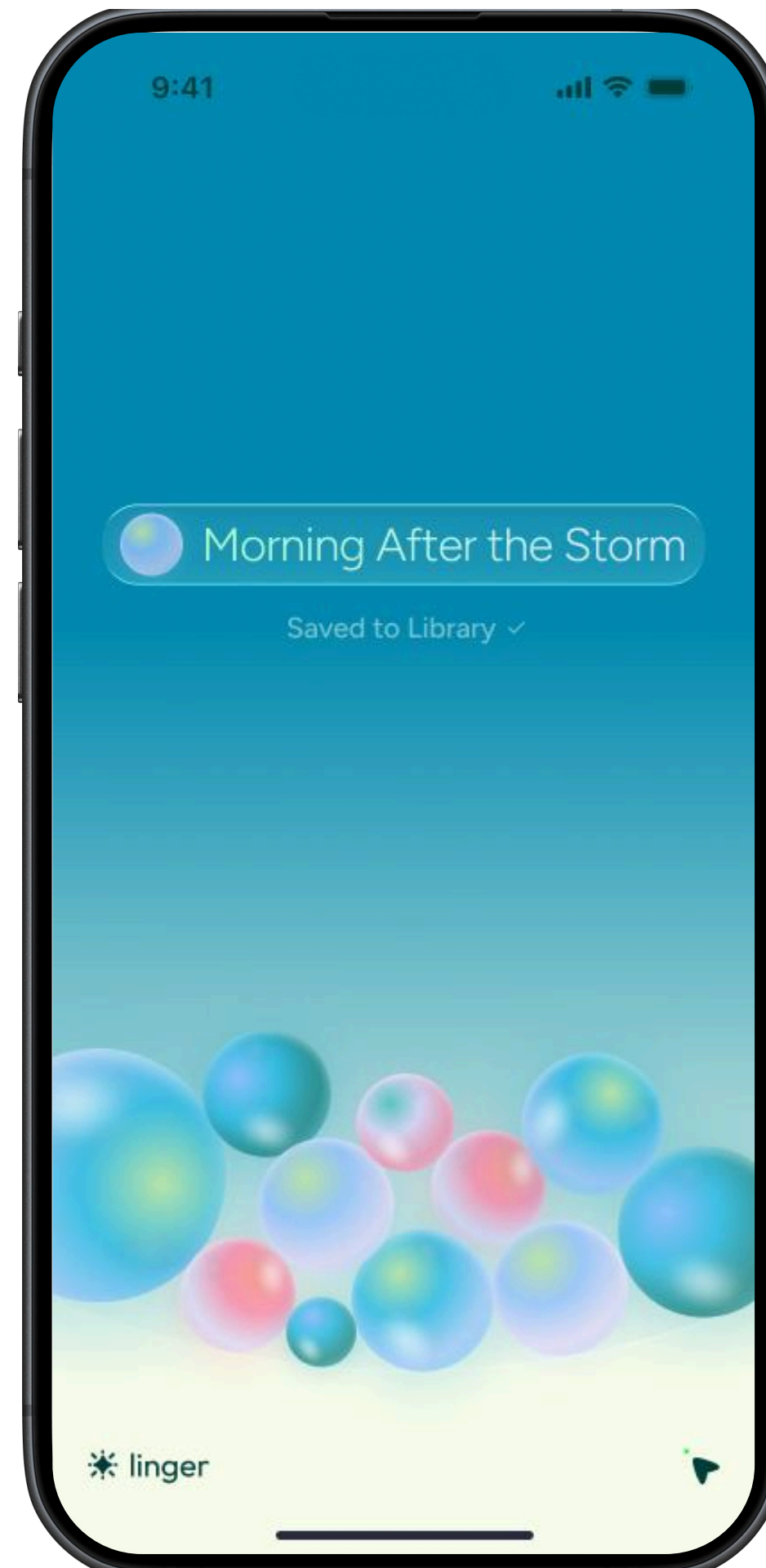
Process

Emma is having tea with her grandfather on a rainy afternoon. She wants to remember this exact feeling, knowing a standard photo would not capture the deep comfort and peace of the moment.

She opens the Linger app to save the scent and cherish the moment.



Wellness Goal: Emotional Grounding. Turning a fleeting moment into a permanent biological anchor.



Use Case 1

Capturing the Fleeting Moment

The Impact

Emma successfully preserves a fleeting, invisible experience. She creates a permanent sensory record of her grandfather's presence, allowing her to revisit this moment at any time.

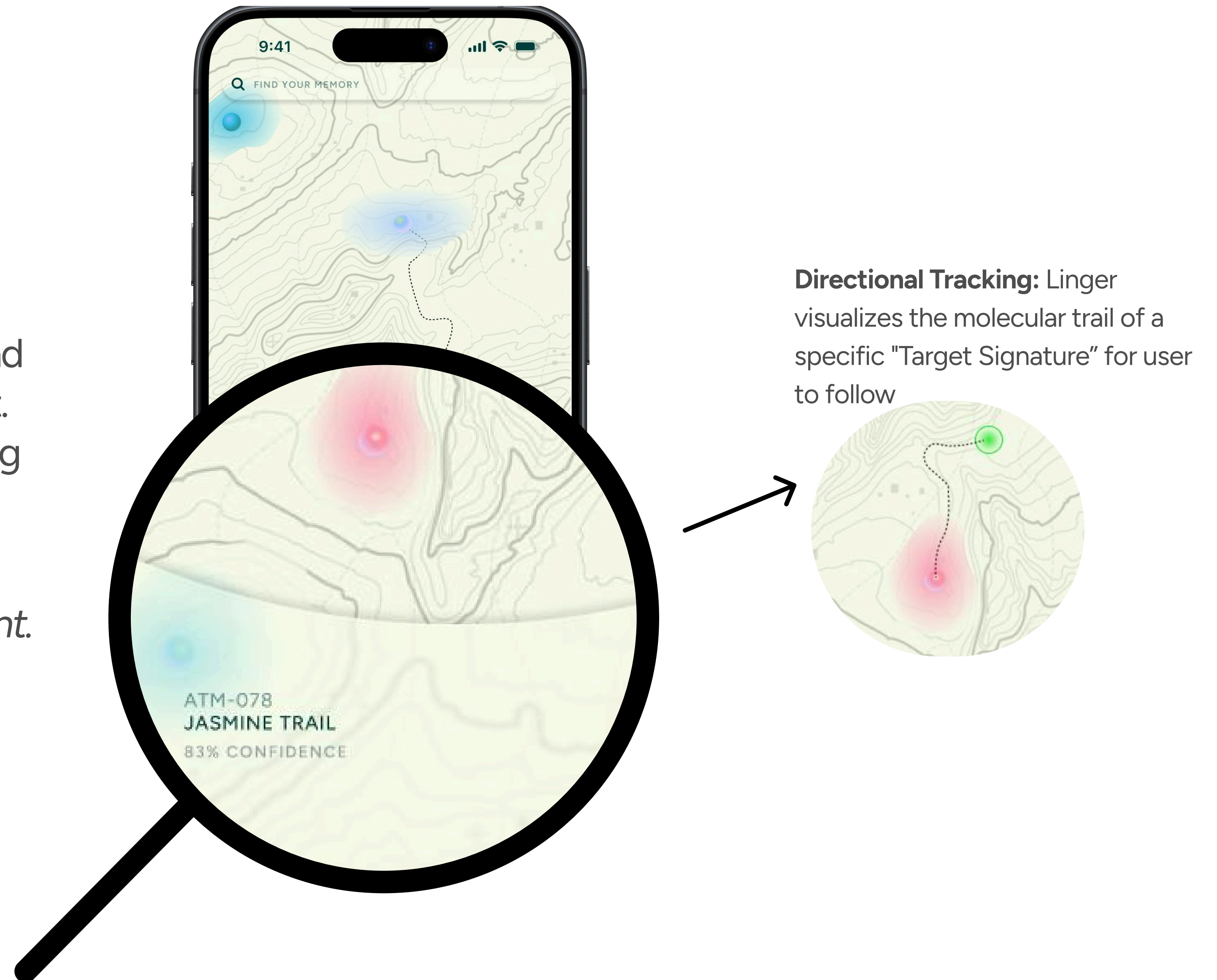
Use Case 2

The Sensory Compass - Locating through Scent Signatures

Process

Samuel is exploring a bustling outdoor market and catches a whiff of a distant, sweet jasmine scent. He wants to find the specific stall that it is coming from midst the chaos.

Linger helps him use a specific signature to find someone or something in a complex environment.

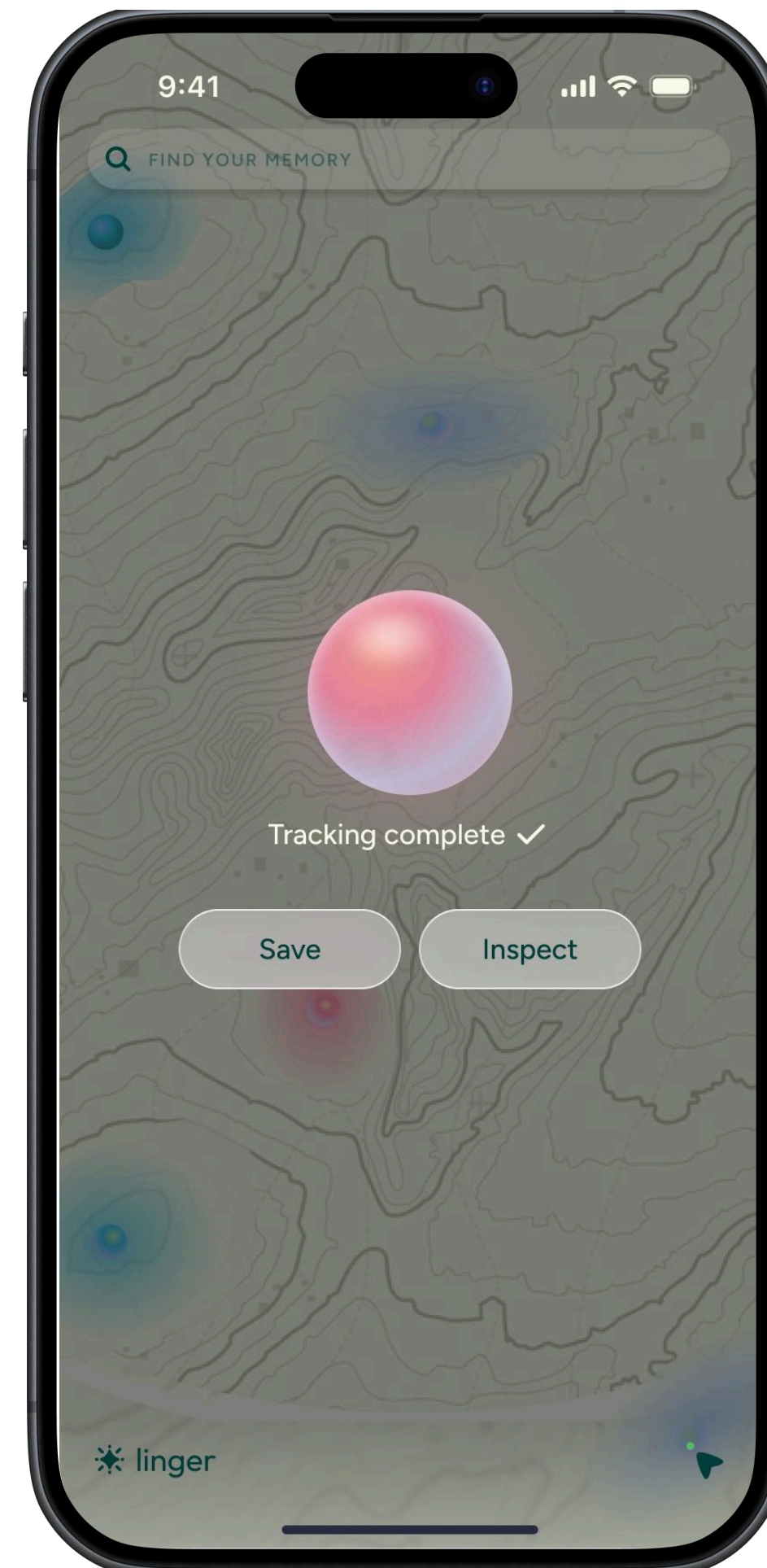


Use Case 2

The Sensory Compass - Locating through Scent Signatures

The Impact

By turning an invisible confusing scent into a clear visual path on his device, Linger helped him cut through the sensory noise to find exactly what he was looking for.



Wellness Goal: Environmental Safety & Autonomy. To reduce cognitive load and anxiety by turning invisible molecular noise into a clear, visual path for navigation.

Use Case 3

The Atmospheric Recall

Process

Amy is a university student who has to study in a sterile, windowless library. The lack of sensory stimulation makes her feel sluggish and disconnected.



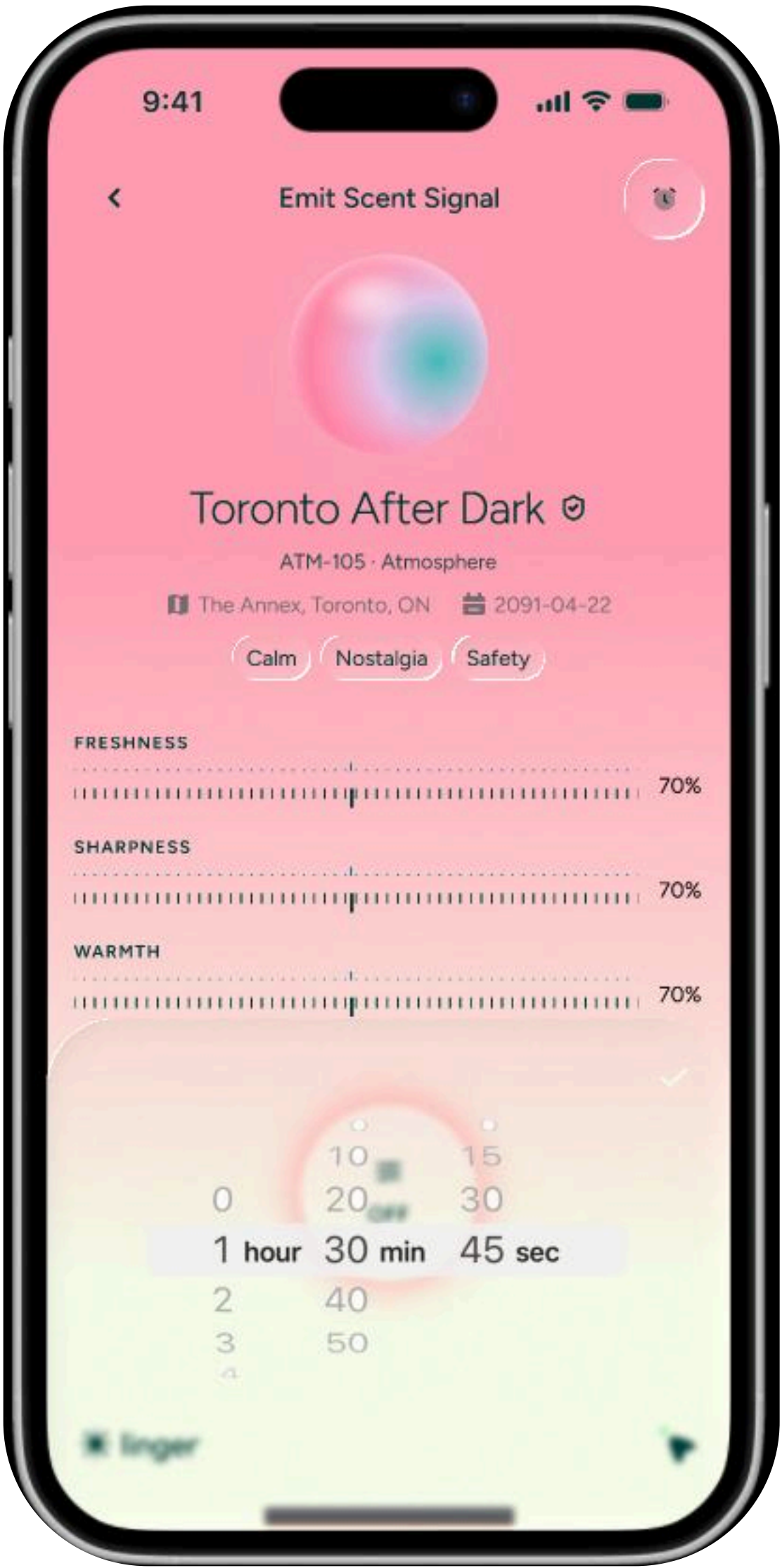
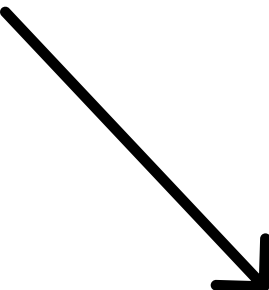
The Atmospheric Recall

The Impact

Her *Linger* wearable emits a personalized sensory sanctuary, triggering a more relaxed and focused state of mind.

Amy opens *Linger* and navigates to her personal scent library. She selects her saved comfort scent, “*Toronto After Dark*” scent.

She taps the emission button, sets the emission to continuous, and confirms her choices.

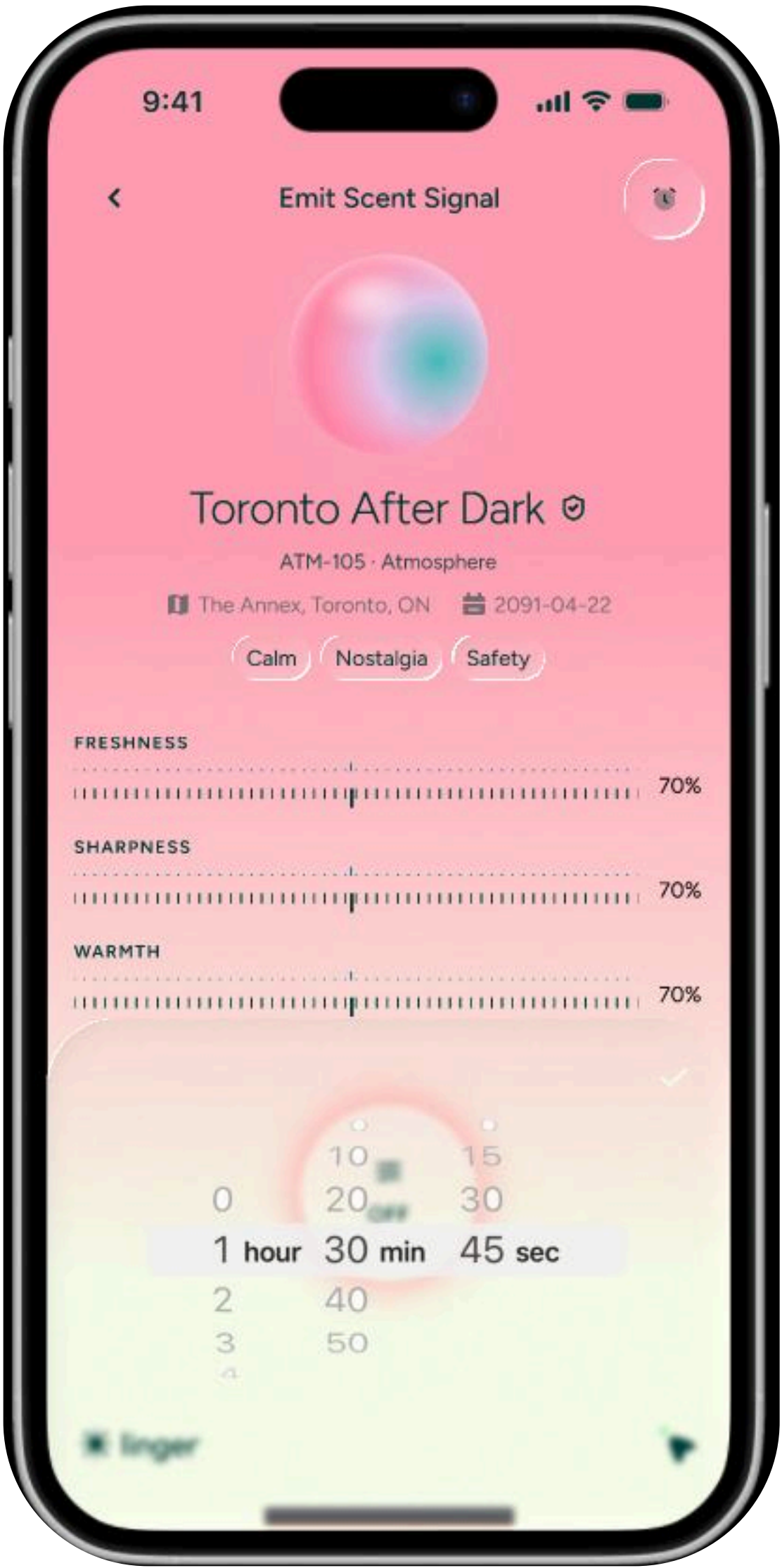


The Atmospheric Recall

The Impact

By grounding herself in a comforting atmosphere, Amy improves her productivity and mental clarity in an otherwise draining space.

Wellness Goal: Achieve nervous system regulation in environments that otherwise cause sensory disconnection or dissonance.



Safeguards & Ethics

Extra perception comes with extra responsibility.



Radical Privacy

- Encrypted Consent: Direct device-to-device "handshake" required to unlock human biological signatures.
- Local Sovereignty: 100% of molecular data is processed on-device; your "Quantified Soul" never touches the cloud.



Physical Safety

- Active Neutralizer: "Palate Cleanser" to purge scent from the nose if needed.
- Hazardous Block: Restricted library prevents the capture or emission of toxic or industrial chemicals.
- Emergency Pulse: A persistent, high-contrast UI button for immediate system-wide shutdown.

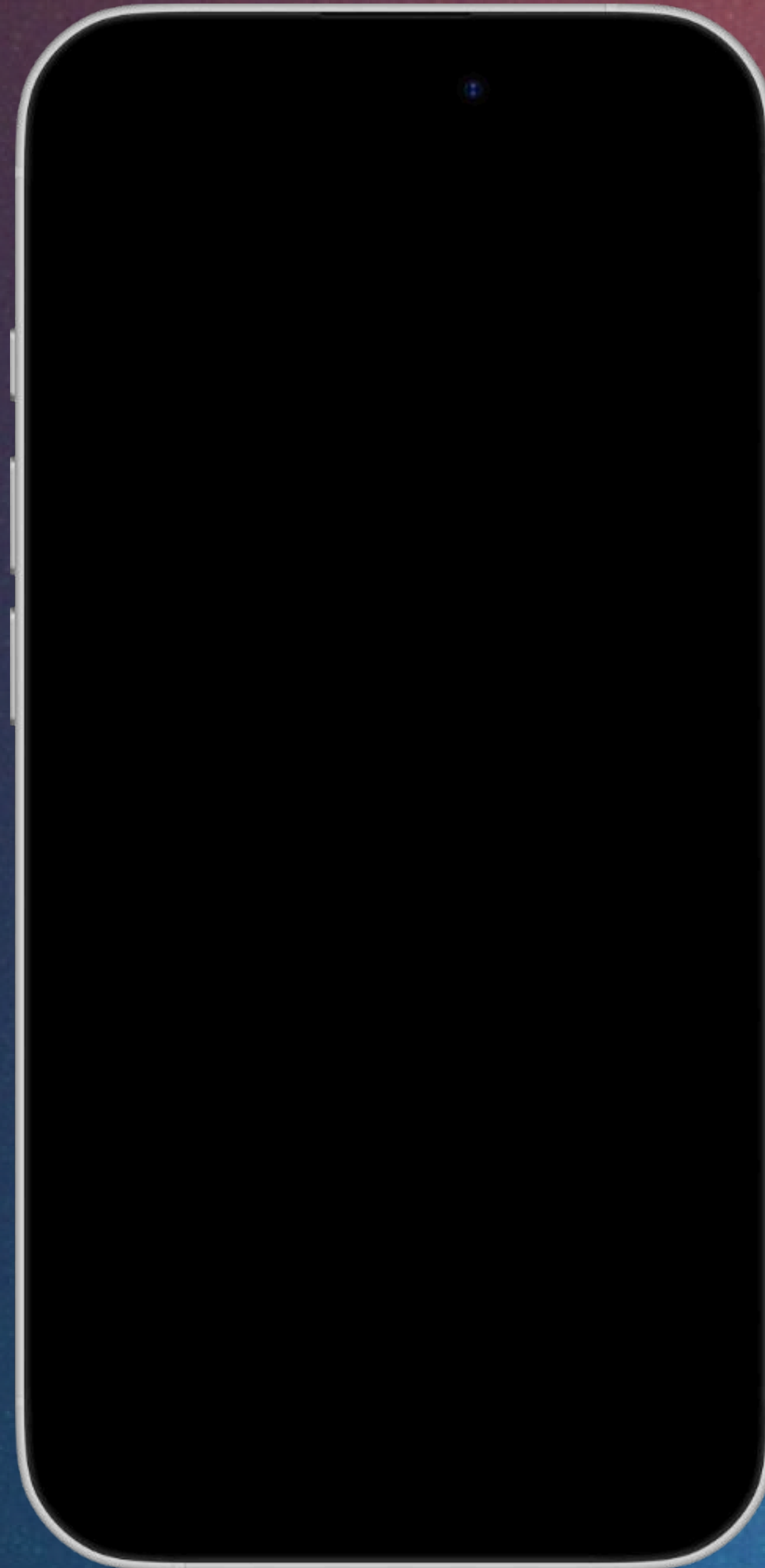


Emotional Wellness

- The Half-Life Protocol: Digital scents naturally soften over 10 years to honor the biological grace of forgetting.
- PTSD Fail-Safe: Real-time Heart Rate Variability (HRV) monitoring auto-stops emission if high stress is detected.
- Anti-Escapism: Usage limits ensure users remain grounded in their physical present.

Prototype

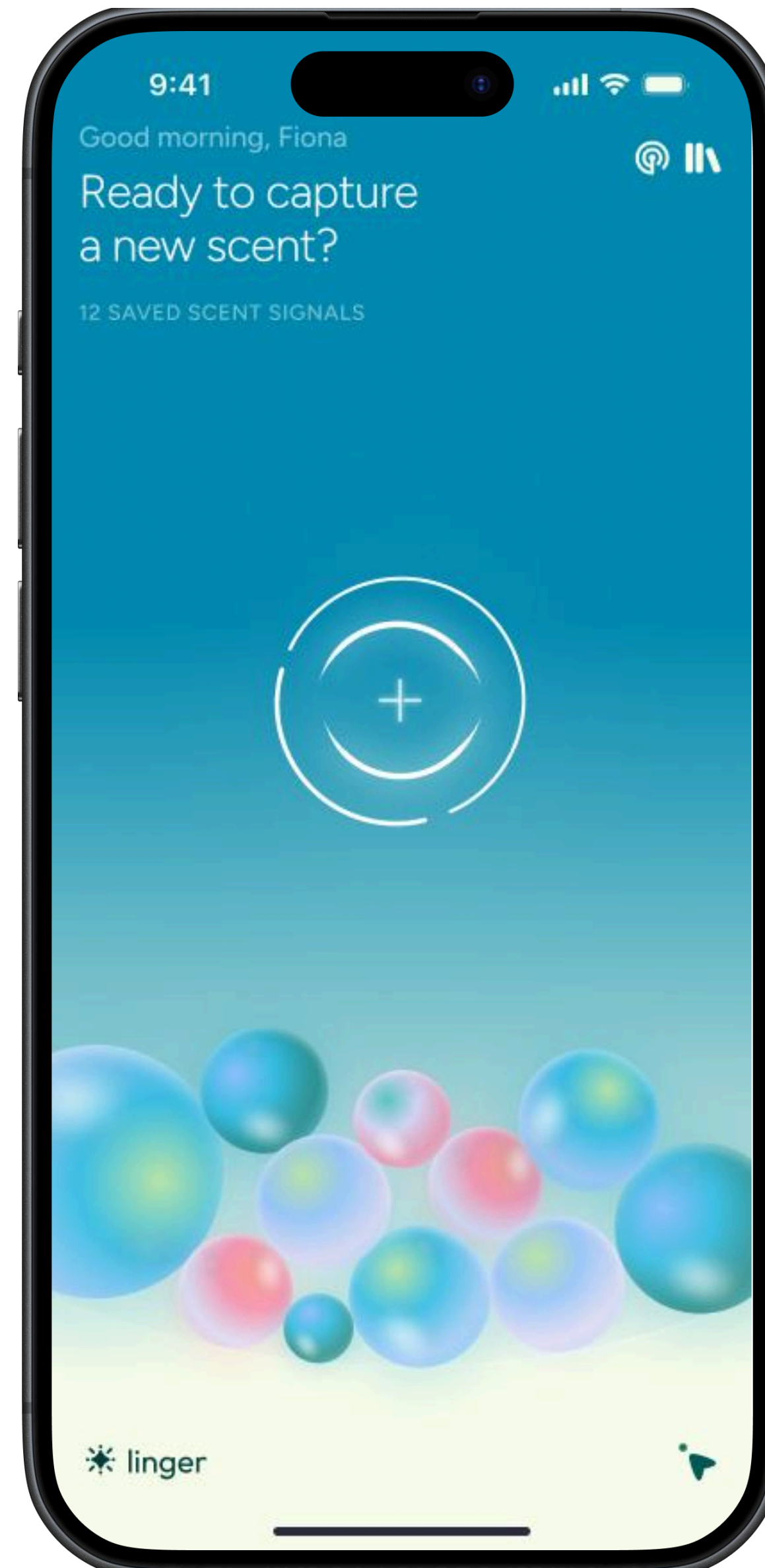
Prototype Link
Click Here!



The Only Sense That Never Forgets

The Core Realization

While photos remind us of what a moment looked like, *Linger* restores *how that moment made us feel*.



Our Lasting Impact

We have turned an overlooked background sensation into a practical tool for everyday understanding.

We have bridged the gap between biological limitation and the permanence of emotional memory.

A photograph reminds you that a moment
happened. A scent takes you back to it.

Because some moments should *linger*.



Because some moments should linger.